

My headteacher is a vampire rat

My headteacher is a vampire rat, a children's book that focuses on comedy mystery imagination and over exaggeration. The story is about a set of students that believe their teacher is a secret vampire rat that runs around the school corridors which creates a chaotic atmosphere. This inspired me to create a stealth based endless runner set within a school environment ideally in a school corridor. In this game, the player must be a student who runs from the vampire teacher who is chasing him through the corridors. There will be mechanics such as AI enemies which can be other students who are pancaking and causing a congestion in the corridor, collectibles for things like power ups and abilities that can help the player create a distance between the teacher and the player. Another cool mechanic which I could introduce into the game is the bell ringing, which increases the speed of the game for a small period and increases congestion in the corridor. There will be no way to kill/beat the teacher as it is an endless runner

The star whale:

The star whale by Nicolas Davies presents a more emotional and imaginative approach because it focusses more on themes of loneliness and hope. The story is about a whale in space which acts as a companion for a child which creates a calm and soothing atmosphere in the story. The player could avoid obstacles such as asteroids meteors and space junk. There could also be a zero-gravity effect to really immerse the player into the space theme of the game. There can also be visuals such as stars and asteroids in the background whilst also having a dark background, I also would want the obstacles to follow the idea of zero gravity by having them float up and down to give that effect. Some more mechanics which I could add are boosters which make the player travel faster to gain score faster however the player will have to do a risk and skills assessment on the spot as the game will also be harder as the obstacles will be moving a lot faster towards them

The darkest dark:

The darkest dark by Chris Hadfield explores fear and imagination. The story is about a child in a bedroom but due to the child's own fear and imagination it transitions into space which shows how the child's fear takes him to other places. The player could be in an endless runner where the tempo and the pace of the game drastically increases and the player will go through portals which will completely change the surroundings to really

underline how the fear of the player changes the surroundings alongside the pace and temp of the game. The game will start off really slow with a slow and gradual increase of temp and speed and I will keep speeding up until it's really fast and then the player goes through a portal which takes them somewhere else where the game is slow again and the speed will slowly build up again. The fear in the game could be implemented by the fear of the darkness and the fear of the unknown. I could also add small lighting to really immerse it into that aspect.

Games research:

Among us;

Game Mechanics:

Among us is a highly social game as a team of 10 people have to work together on a ship completing tasks which keep the ship flying however there is an imposter among the crew who is sabotaging the ship and is pretending to complete tasks to blend in whilst slowly killing the crew mates it is up to the team to work together and to identify who the imposter is before the imposter takes everyone out. This causes the players to engage as it is a different style of game as it doesn't require any physical skill but rather the ability to socialize and convince others who is right and wrong for both the crewmates and the imposters.

Level design approaches:

The level design in Among us is simple yet comfortable really giving that home feeling to the player with a clear simple structure to the layout of the map. Each section and area of the map has a clear purpose with different areas having different tasks for example the engines will have a fueling up task and the electrical sections have electrical tasks. The smooth corridors leading to rooms are all easy to understand which creates a friendly game that is easy to understand.

Player interactions:

In Among us there is a large variety of controls and mechanics available which involves completing a variety of different tasks, reporting dead bodies and engaging in discussing

and voting. This creates a huge engaging environment allowing the players onto not only engage with the game but to also engage with each other a lot.

Visual style:

The visual style of among us is minimalistic colorful and cartoon like which in my opinion makes it look friendly and something which everyone can relate to in the sense that they have experienced this style of visuals in other aspects of their life. This makes it so that the game is more accessible to a wider range of audience and is also easy to understand. For my game I would like to stick to the same visual style as in among us which also ensures its suitable for younger gamers.

Hello Neighbor:

Game mechanics:

Hello neighbors is based on stealth and exploring mechanics where the player sneaks into the house to discover secrets whilst trying to not get caught. The game has a variety of different ways of completing the game which can be done in things like hidng, distracting the enemy ai with things like noise and finding different routes. The tension in this game is created through the fear of being caught which inspired me to add an audio t my game which will be similar to jaws

Level design:

The level design in hello neighbor allows played to explore freely almost like n open world game but in a house

Player interactive systems:

Player interactions in hello neighbor consist of things like picking up items unlocking doors using objects o distract enemies, using objects to distract enemies with noise

Visual style:

The visual style of hello neighbor is like a hyper cartoonish game which is super bright with bright contrasting colors almost as if it was done deliberately to create a certain visual style. The design creates a funny atmosphere in the game which increases the age range of the game allowing more people to play the game. In my game I would use similar mechanics but not as bright or as contrasting as in hello neighbor.

Game systems:

The game systems in hello neighbour are actually extremely good and have systems which I have researched once in my 2 years of doing this course, hello neighbor has an adaptive Ai which learns from the players actions and habits to counter them to create a more challenging game over time for the player which causes the player to adapt their techniques and strategies to counter the adaptive enemy ai who is also trying to counter them which increases engagement a lot as there is a lot of thinking ahead which is needed.

Mechanics I want to implement:

From hello neighbor I would like to implement progressive features in my game I would also include a simple ai system which responds to the players actions the mechanics are important because that's the design approach I'm going for.

Baldi's basics;

Game mechanics:

Baldi's basics is a very simple game in terms of mechanics however the way that the mechanics are used is what makes the game memorable for those who played it. The game is very basic with the player just collecting notebooks whilst trying to avoid being caught by Baldi however the more notebooks to collect the more the difficulty increases. The mechanics in the game are relatively basic with just movement and awareness mechanics meaning the engagement in the game comes from the game experience.

Level design approaches:

The level design in Baldi's Basics is the most low quality and basic I have ever seen from a game. However, the developers of this game used that to their advantage by targeting a lower age group as their target audience and building the game around something which everyone has done or is currently doing, which is school/education. They build the game around confusion, mazes, and pressure on the player. This way, the player immerses into the game as they are trying desperately to figure it out. There are aspects in the game where Baldi becomes more aggressive and faster, which ensures that the player does not get bored of the game as the difficulty is constantly increasing.

Mechanics I want to implement:

The main mechanic from Hello Neighbor which grabs my attention is the fact that Baldi slowly increases in difficulty and speed, which increases the difficulty of the game and allows the player to enjoy the game for longer as compared to a game where the difficulty stays the same throughout the game. It becomes predictable and boring for the player to want to continue.

Visuals:

The visual/art style in Baldi's Basics is intentionally really simple and low quality in order to resemble old educational games from the 1990's. The visuals and colors and art style create a false sense of safety and security for the player, and it makes the game feel welcoming and safe, which is far from the true nature of the game.

Game systems:

In Baldi's Basics, it is a horror-based game where players explore a school and collect notebooks. The player needs to solve puzzles like math questions or English questions.

and use their stamina smartly to avoid baldi it is mainly an exploration game with good resource management

Things I would add

I really like the idea of collecting notebooks to use later on in the game strategically so I will make the attempt to add something similar to mine

Geometry dash

Geometry dash is a 2d rhythm-based platformer designed game made on the 13th of august 2013 and was released on iOS android and windows macOS

Game Mechanic:

The game has only 1 mechanic which is to jump as your character/block moves forward on its own without stopping which leads the player to remain engaged and to jump when necessary to avoid failing the level by hitting an obstacle this urges the player to remain focused because if they look away from the game they are at a high risk of failing the level and having to restart from the beginning.

Game Feature:

Geometry dash also includes a progress bar at the top which shows to the player how much of the level they have completed in a percentage this helps keep the reader engaged because if the player

is close to completing the level it causes the player to focus more to ensure he can make it to the end and also creates a sense of urgency because if the player knows he is close to the end he is going to become nervous knowing that if he fails he will have to do the level again from the start.

Game Soundtrack:

The game also consists of soundtracks which are matching of the level that is being played for example if a player is playing a level that requires fast reactions the soundtrack will also be matching of that and will be a song with a fast beat which is proven to get the players heart beating faster.

Developed By:

Geometry dash was developed by Robert Topola which he first described as being “bouncy ball thingy as a fun side project that might even get me a little spending money. He spent 3 months developing geometry dash and claims to have basic programming knowledge.

The Games Art Style:

The art style in geometry dash is characterized by its use of geometric shapes bright and contrasting colors and dynamic animations.

